BA | LAB 1

Requirements That Can Actually Be Tested

Eight vague healthcare requirements rewritten until a tester needs no translator. Correctly is not a requirement.

What this proves: Requirements work that ends arguments instead of starting them, from real healthcare business analysis practice.

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Recreated from real BA work at CVS Health/Aetna and Flagstar Bank. No employer data.

The problem

A healthcare release arrived with requirements written as intentions: the system should handle duplicate submissions correctly. Nobody could test that sentence, and every reader understood it differently.

How I built it

1. Listed the data states each requirement lives in: valid, duplicate, late, reversed, past dated, future dated, terminated yesterday.
2. Rewrote each requirement with an actor, a condition, and an observable result. Removed every handle correctly type phrase.
3. Wrote acceptance criteria for the happy path and the two highest risk negative paths.
4. Attached the business or regulatory reason to each requirement, so priority has something to stand on.
5. Built traceability: requirement to criteria to test case to defect.
6. Ran the stranger test: a case must be writable from the requirement alone, without messaging the author.

Validation, expected vs actual

Check	Method	Result
Testable by a stranger	Case written from the text alone	8 of 8 after rewrite, 2 of 8 before
Data states named	Matrix review	8 of 8 requirements
Criteria traced to cases	Traceability matrix	24 criteria, 24 test cases

Example: before, the system should handle duplicate claims correctly. After, a full rule naming the duplicate window, the hold, the first claim shown to the reviewer, and no payment until release or denial.

The finding

Two of eight original requirements were testable as written. Eight of eight were after the rewrite. First drafts are thinking, and thinking is fine. The BA work is turning it into something a team can build and test without the author standing in the room.

Deliverables in this lab

- 8 before and after requirements
- Acceptance criteria set, 24 items
- Traceability matrix sample

Skills shown: Business analysis, requirements, acceptance criteria, Agile, backlog refinement, UAT, healthcare IT, Jira, Azure DevOps